CASH TO COMPANY

Item Bank

"Businesses need a simple plan"

Per-unit quiz / test items · 4 units · ETS-quality alignment to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS

Grade 4 — Cash to Company Item Bank

Year theme: *Businesses need a simple plan.* This bank covers all four Grade 4 units (Read a real business · The Reality Check · The $50 Plan · The One-Page Plan defense). Items use short text + multistep math (CCSS 4.OA.A.3, 4.MD.A.2). Distractors target the Common Misconceptions table for Grade 4. No family-money probes; "for a hypothetical" framing throughout. Cash's Grade 4 voice: "*A plan is just five honest answers in a row. Start with one.*"

Unit 1: Read a real business

MC1. Cash reads a profile: "Bento Buddies sells $8 lunch boxes at office buildings. They make 50 a day, paying $5 in ingredients and $1 in delivery per box. Customers are office workers who don't have time to leave for lunch." Who is the customer?

A. Bento Buddies · B. Office workers who can't leave for lunch · C. Restaurants · D. Anyone hungry

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CCSS-ELA W.4.4 — Produce clear and coherent writing.* · **Strand outcome (BAVC, 4):** *I can read or watch a short business profile and summarize what the business does, who it helps, and how it makes money in 3-5 sentences.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*A 'customer' is everyone*" — D baits this, B is specific.

MC2. "From the Bento Buddies profile, what is profit per box?"

A. $8 · B. $5 · C. $2 · D. $1

Answer: C · **Standard:** *CCSS-Math 4.OA.A.3 — Multistep word problems.* · **Strand outcome (MFL, 4):** *I can fill in a 1-page budget for a small classroom event with at least 4 categories that does not exceed a $50 cap, showing all subtotals.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Profit is whatever's left in the cash drawer*" — A is revenue; B is one cost component; C = $8 - $5 - $1.

MC3. "How does Bento Buddies make money?"

A. They make a thing (boxes), sell to a specific customer (office workers), at a price ($8) above cost ($6) · B. They are lucky · C. They have a cool name · D. The boxes are pretty

Answer: A · **Standard:** *C3 D2.Eco.4.3-5 — Explain why incentives vary between buyers and sellers.* · **Strand outcome (BAVC, 4):** *I can read or watch a short business profile and summarize what the business does, who it helps, and how it makes money.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Businesses succeed by luck or vibes*" — corrects.

SA1. "Read the Bento Buddies profile. Summarize in 3-5 sentences: (a) what the business does, (b) who it helps, (c) how it makes money."

Model answer: "*Bento Buddies sells lunch boxes for $8 at offices. They help office workers who can't leave during lunch. Each box costs them $6 to make and deliver, so they earn $2 profit per box. They sell 50 a day, which means $100 profit a day.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** All three elements present AND a per-day or per-box profit number is right. - **2:** Two of three; or numbers off by small amount. - **1:** Only one element.

SA2. "The Bento Buddies profile says 'office workers.' Name three customers who are NOT their target. Why?"

Model answer: "*Stay-at-home parents (already home for lunch). Restaurant diners (already eating out). Kids (don't pay $8 for lunch). They aren't office workers under time pressure.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Three real "non-target" customers each with a reason. - **2:** Two valid non-targets. - **1:** One or fewer.

Performance Task: Real-Business Profile (45 min, individual; teacher-curated profile bank).

Child reads a teacher-supplied 1-page profile of a real local business, then writes a 3-5 sentence summary using "what / who / how it makes money" framing, plus a 1-sentence "one thing I'd want to know that's not in the profile." **Rubric:** Reflection Writing Rubric (Grade 4): (1) all three what/who/how elements named, (2) at least one specific number cited, (3) the missing-info question is sharp. **Strand outcome:** BAVC + MFL.

Extension (advanced learner):

"*Bento Buddies wants to grow. Pick ONE: raise price to $9, cut cost to $5 total, or sell 60 boxes a day. Which gives the biggest profit boost? Show your math.*" Model: $1 price boost × 50 = +$50/day; $1 cost cut × 50 = +$50/day; 10 extra boxes × $2 = +$20/day — price or cost beats volume here.

Unit 2: The Reality Check

MC1. The 5-question Reality Check is: Who buys? How much? How many? What does it cost me? What's left? Cash asks: Which question is the "profit" question?

A. Who buys? · B. How many? · C. What does it cost me? · D. What's left?

Answer: D · **Standard:** *Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 4-3 — Apply the steps of a decision-making process.* · **Strand outcome (PSIG, 4):** *I can take an idea and run it through a 5-question "Reality Check" and write reasonable estimates.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Profit is the same as revenue*" — corrects.

MC2. "Your idea: hand-painted phone cases for $15. Materials cost $4 each. You estimate selling 6 a week." What's your weekly profit estimate?

A. $90 · B. $66 · C. $24 · D. $11

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CCSS-Math 4.OA.A.3 — Multistep word problems.* · **Strand outcome (PSIG, 4):** *I can take an idea and run it through a 5-question "Reality Check" and write reasonable estimates.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Profit doesn't matter as long as the sale happens*" — A is revenue, C is cost; B = $15-$4 × 6 = $66.

MC3. "You estimate selling 6 phone cases a week. A friend asks, 'How do you know it's 6?' Which answer is the most honest?"

A. 'It's a feeling.' · B. 'I asked 10 friends; 3 said they'd buy at $15. I'm guessing 6 in a busy week, fewer in slow weeks.' · C. 'Everyone will want one.' · D. 'I just hope so.'

Answer: B · **Standard:** *NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-2 — Generate and compare multiple solutions.* · **Strand outcome (PSIG, 4):** *I can take an idea and run it through a 5-question "Reality Check" and write reasonable estimates.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*If I plan it, it'll happen exactly that way*" — corrects with evidence-led estimation.

SA1. "For a hypothetical bracelet business: $1 cost per bracelet, $5 sale price, 8 bracelets a week. Run the 5-question Reality Check. Write each answer in 1 sentence."

Model answer: "*1. Who buys? Classmates and friends who like bracelets. 2. How much? $5 each. 3. How many? 8 per week is the estimate. 4. What does it cost? $1 per bracelet, so $8 a week. 5. What's left? $40 revenue minus $8 cost = $32 profit per week.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** All five answered AND the math is right ($32). - **2:** All five answered but math wrong, OR one question skipped. - **1:** Multiple skipped.

SA2. "Write a 1-sentence customer statement for the bracelet business: 'This is for ___ who needs ___.'"

Model answer: "*This is for kids who like wearing bracelets but want a one-of-a-kind one their friend doesn't already have.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Both blanks specific (not "everyone," not "kids who want bracelets"). - **2:** One blank specific. - **1:** Both vague.

Performance Task: 5-Question Reality Check + Customer Statement (45 min, individual).

Child picks one of three teacher-supplied prompts (lemonade stand, bracelet stand, lawn-care service), runs the 5-question Reality Check with reasonable estimates, and writes a 1-sentence customer statement. **Rubric:** Customer Research Rubric (Grade 4): (1) all 5 questions answered, (2) numbers internally consistent, (3) customer statement passes the "name three non-customers" test. **Strand outcome:** PSIG + CBM + MFL.

Extension (advanced learner):

"*What's the WORST week (lowest sales) you could imagine? Run the Reality Check again with that worst-case number. Are you still profitable?*" Targets sensitivity-analysis seed; previews Grade 8.

Unit 3: The $50 Plan

MC1. "For a hypothetical class party budget capped at $50, your categories are: snacks ($25), decorations ($10), drinks ($10), supplies ($8). What is your total? Are you under cap?"

A. $43, no · B. $53, no · C. $43, yes · D. $50 exactly, yes

Answer: C · **Standard:** *CCSS-Math 4.MD.A.2 — Use the four operations to solve word problems involving money.* · **Strand outcome (MFL, 4):** *I can fill in a 1-page budget for a small classroom event with at least 4 categories that does not exceed a $50 cap, showing all subtotals.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*A budget is a wish list*" — corrects with a real total.

MC2. "Your decorations subtotal is $10, but a real check shows $14. What's the right move?"

A. Pretend it's still $10 · B. Cut another category by $4 to stay under cap · C. Go over cap; nobody will notice · D. Quit the project

Answer: B · **Standard:** *Jump$tart Standard 1 (Spending and Saving), Benchmark 4-3 — Outline a plan for buying a needed or wanted item.* · **Strand outcome (MFL, 4):** *I can fill in a 1-page budget for a small classroom event with at least 4 categories that does not exceed a $50 cap, showing all subtotals.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*If I plan it, it'll happen exactly that way*" — corrects with the trade-off move.

MC3. "What is the difference between a wish list and a budget?"

A. None — they're the same · B. A wish list says what you want; a budget is a promise about a number · C. A wish list has prices; a budget doesn't · D. A budget is a wish list with sparkles

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CEE Standard 2 (Buying Goods and Services), Grade 4 — Planning for spending can help people make informed choices.* · **Strand outcome (MFL, 4):** *I can fill in a 1-page budget for a small classroom event.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*A budget is a wish list*" — corrects directly.

SA1. "For a hypothetical $40 class movie night, build a 4-category budget that totals exactly $40. Show subtotals."

Model answer: "*Snacks: $18 (popcorn $8, candy $10). Drinks: $12. Decorations: $6. Supplies (cups/plates/napkins): $4. Total: $40.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** All 4 categories named, subtotals add to exactly $40, no double-counting. - **2:** Adds to $40 but only 3 categories OR small math error. - **1:** Doesn't add to $40 or fewer than 3 categories.

SA2. "You wrote a $40 budget. Halfway through planning, snacks went up by $5. Show your revision: which category did you cut, by how much, and why?"

Model answer: "*I cut decorations from $6 to $1 — saved $5. Decorations matter least to making the night fun; the snacks matter most.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Cut named, math works (still $40), reason is customer-led ("matters most/least to the experience"). - **2:** Math works but reason is vague. - **1:** Math doesn't work.

Performance Task: $50 Plan with Trade-off Memo (60 min over 2 sessions).

Child builds a 4-category budget under a $50 cap for a chosen classroom event, with subtotals, plus a 3-sentence trade-off memo: "I picked X over Y because [customer reason]." **Rubric:** Budget Project Rubric (Grade 4): (1) all 4 categories, (2) subtotals correct, (3) trade-off memo specific. **Strand outcome:** MFL + ESL.

Extension (advanced learner):

"*You realize you forgot tax (8%) on the snacks. What does that do to your budget? Show your re-balance.*" Targets tax math; previews Grade 9 compliance.

Unit 4: The One-Page Plan defense

MC1. "A 1-page business plan should NOT include..."

A. The customer · B. The price · C. A claim like 'this will make me rich' · D. The cost

Answer: C · **Standard:** *CCSS-ELA W.4.4 — Produce clear and coherent writing.* · **Strand outcome (OSO, 4):** *I can build a 1-page business plan template (idea, customer, price, costs, plan) and complete it for one idea.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Bigger claims make a stronger plan*" — corrects with the brand "no wealth promise" rule.

MC2. "The one-page plan asks for the CUSTOMER. Which is the strongest answer?"

A. Everyone · B. Kids · C. 4th-graders who eat snacks between classes · D. Somebody who has money

Answer: C · **Standard:** *CCSS-ELA W.4.4.* · **Strand outcome (CBM, 4):** *I can write a 1-sentence "this is for ___ who needs ___" customer statement for my business idea.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*A 'customer' is everyone*" — corrects directly.

MC3. "Your before-plan said 'sell 50 cookies a week.' Your after-plan says '15-20 cookies a week.' This change is..."

A. A failure — your plan got smaller · B. A revision — you got more honest after seeing real evidence · C. A mistake to hide · D. Cheating

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CCSS-ELA W.4.5 — Develop and strengthen writing through revision.* · **Strand outcome (LRCI, 4):** *I can compare a "before" and "after" version of my plan and circle three changes I made and why.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Revision is admitting you were wrong, which is bad*" — corrects with "honest revision is the work."

SA1. "Write a 1-sentence customer statement for your one-page plan idea, in this format: 'This is for ___ who needs ___.'"

Model answer: "*This is for 4th-graders who get hungry between recess and lunch and want a snack under $1.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Both blanks are specific (age + behavior on the customer side; specific need with a constraint on the need side). - **2:** One blank specific, one vague. - **1:** Both vague.

SA2. "Show me three changes between your before-plan and your after-plan. For each, write 'I changed X because Y.'"

Model answer: "*1. I changed price from $2 to $1.25 because my interview said 'over $1.50 is too much.' 2. I changed the cookie count from 30 to 15 because my supplies cap me at 15. 3. I changed my customer from 'kids' to '4th-graders' because the snack cart already covers older grades.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Three changes, each with a specific reason rooted in evidence. - **2:** Two changes with reasons. - **1:** One change or no reasons.

Performance Task: One-Page Plan Defense (60 min planning + 4 min peer panel).

Child completes a 1-page plan template (idea, customer, price, costs, plan), creates a "before/after" diff sheet showing 3 specific revisions, and defends it in a 4-minute peer panel that asks 2 questions. **Rubric:** Business Plan Rubric (Grade 4 scale-down: 4 criteria — customer clarity, value prop, financial logic, communication): (1) plan complete with all 5 elements, (2) before/after diff with 3 specific revisions, (3) panel questions answered with evidence, not "I just thought so." **Strand outcome:** OSO + CBM + LRCI.

Extension (advanced learner):

"*In your panel, the toughest question was '___'. Write a 1-paragraph revision to your plan based on that question.*" Builds the revision-as-strength move; previews Grade 8 PDSA.

Total this grade: 12 MC + 8 SA + 4 Performance Tasks + 4 Extensions = 28 items.